

Christopher Amen Kola

Software Engineer

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Portfolio: personal-portfolio.gram.vercel.app

Open-Source Contributor on PyPI | 100+ Docker Hub Pulls (CommitGen CLI) | WeThinkCode_ Alumnus

Summary

Full-stack software engineer who genuinely loves building things that work well and ship fast. I'm a generalist at heart, strong across both frontend and backend with Java, Python, JavaScript, and React, but I lean towards backend development, CI/CD pipelines, and cloud infrastructure on AWS. I've shipped a WhatsApp automation bot that handles ~1,000 messages a day for a real client, published an open-source CLI tool to PyPI and Docker Hub, and mentored the next cohort of developers at WeThinkCode_. I'm an AI-forward developer. I use LLMs and AI tooling daily to move faster without cutting corners on quality. I'm at my best in a team: pair programming, honest code reviews, and building something bigger than what any one person could do alone.

Technical Skills

Languages: Java (primary), Python, JavaScript/Node.js, Bash

Backend & Frameworks: Spring Boot, Javalin, Express.js, React

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Bedrock, IAM, Amplify), Docker, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions

Testing & Methods: TDD, JUnit, pytest, Agile/Scrum, Pair Programming

Data & Networking: SQL, ORM, DynamoDB, TCP/UDP, HTTP, DNS, REST APIs

Experience

Freelance WhatsApp Automation Developer (Freelance Contract)

Blossom Blooms | Remote | May 2025 – Jan 2026

- Built and maintained a WhatsApp chatbot handling ~1,000 automated messages/day, cutting the client's manual response workload by roughly 90%.
- Designed intelligent routing and automated product link distribution using Node.js, Python, and the Baileys WhatsApp API.
- Achieved zero-downtime availability by self-hosting with Ngrok tunneling and proactive monitoring.

Bootcamp Mentor & Python Workshop Facilitator

WeThinkCode_ | Johannesburg | Aug – Oct 2025

- Taught Python fundamentals, debugging techniques, and CLI tooling to incoming bootcamp cohorts.
- Guided learners through algorithmic challenges and Linux/dev environment setup, building their independence as developers.
- Reviewed candidate submissions and wrote structured evaluations for the selection process.

HPE Software Engineering Job Simulation

Hewlett Packard Enterprise (Forage) | Jan 2026

- Built a RESTful Spring Boot service for employee record management, passing all endpoint integration tests.
- Achieved 100% test coverage on core business logic with JUnit, validating behaviour across all service endpoints.

Projects

CommitGen — AI-Powered Git CLI Tool

Python, Docker, OpenAI API, GitHub Actions

github.com/Ckola99/commit-gen

Published on PyPI | 100+ Docker Hub pulls | Multi-stage Docker builds | CI/CD to PyPI + Docker Hub

- Developed a CLI tool that analyses staged Git diffs and generates Conventional Commit messages using OpenAI's API.
- Containerised with multi-stage Docker builds and automated dual deployment via GitHub Actions.

Brownfields Robot Worlds Platform — Distributed Systems

Java, Docker, TCP, SQL, GitLab CI/CD

github.com/Ckola99/Robot-worlds-brownfields

- Modernised a legacy TCP robot-control system into a modular layered architecture with a Javalin REST API.
- Containerised all services and automated Docker image building/publishing via GitLab CI/CD pipelines.

AWS CloudFunFacts Generator — Serverless Application

AWS Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Bedrock, Python

github.com/Ckola99/CloudFunFacts

Live: production.d11q6mprl0gz9y.amplifyapp.com

- Deployed a fully serverless app end-to-end: API Gateway to Lambda to DynamoDB, with optional AI enhancement via AWS Bedrock.
- Automated DynamoDB provisioning and data seeding with boto3 and AWS CLI, configured IAM policies and CORS.

Audiophile E-Commerce Website — Full-Featured React Storefront

React, Redux, Tailwind CSS, React Hook Form, React Router

github.com/Ckola99/Ecom-site

Live: ecom-site-five.vercel.app

- Built a multi-page e-commerce storefront with product browsing, cart management, and a full checkout flow including form validation with Yup schemas.
- Implemented Redux for global state management with localStorage persistence, keeping cart contents intact across browser sessions.
- Optimised for performance and SEO with responsive mobile-first design, dynamic meta tags via React Helmet, and Lighthouse-driven improvements.

Kanban Task Management App — React SPA

React, JavaScript, CSS3

github.com/Ckola99/Kanban-webapp

Live: kanban-web.vercel.app

- Built a responsive task-management dashboard with real-time status tracking and categorised board views.

Education

WeThinkCode_ | Johannesburg, South Africa

Diploma in Software Engineering (Full-Stack) — NQF Level 6

Feb 2025 – May 2026